

WORLD POOL ASSOCIATION

Sanctioning Regulations

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Version 6

SANCTIONING REGULATIONS.

Introduction:

1. Sanctioning is an important feature of all major pool Tournaments. It is a key responsibility of the World Pool Association (**WPA**) at an international level, for its members the six Continental Federations (**CFs**) at a continental level and for its National Federations (**NFs**) at a national level.

   International Tournaments. A tournament is an International Tournament if it has Athletes from two or more continents competing.

   Continental Tournaments. A tournament is a Continental Tournament if it has Athletes from two or more countries within the continent competing or if it is an International Tournament for a Category 5 tournament (i.e. less than USD 60,000 in total prize money) which is not sanctioned or ratified by the WPA

   National Tournaments. A tournament is a National Tournament if it only has Athletes from within the relevant country competing.

2. The WPA has defined the continents for the purpose of these regulations in Appendix A. This definition applies throughout the Rules & Regulations of Pool generally. Our definition adopts the IOC's National Olympic Committee's continental definitions.

3. This document sets out the requirements and benefits of an International Tournament receiving the sanction or ratification of the WPA. If further information or clarification is required, please contact the WPA by email at admin@WPApool.com. These regulations operate with effect from 1 January 2025.

4. The actions of the WPA in dealing with the grant of sanctioning or ratification for an International Tournament may be performed by the WPA's Board or by the Board's duly authorised delegate. The actions of the Sports Director in dealing with the grant of sanctioning or ratification for an International Tournament may be performed by that person's duly authorised delegate. In this document where the context requires, the words an International Tournament includes World Championships.

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International Tournaments

Categories

5. During any year there are many Tournaments organised in the world of Pool. The WPA itself, its members the CFs and their members the NFs, all organise or host Tournaments. In addition, many of the Tournaments are organised by commercial promoters.

6. In these regulations the term "Tournament Organiser" covers both commercial promoters and businesses and also CFs and NFs where they organise Tournaments directly

7. There is a substantial range in the size and significance of Tournaments. International Tournaments are classified by the WPA into the following five categories:

    7.1. **Category 1.** World Championships or Tournaments offering a minimum of USD 220,001 of total prize money;

    7.2. **Category 2.** Tournaments offering between USD 145,001 and USD 220,000 of total prize money;

    7.3. **Category 3.** Tournaments offering between USD 95,001 and USD 145,000 of total prize money;

    7.4. **Category 4.** Tournaments offering between USD 60,001 and USD 95,000 of total prize money; and

    7.5. **Category 5.** Tournaments offering up to USD 60,000 of total prize money.

    Payments to Athletes for appearance money or other costs are not included in the calculation of "total prize money".

8. Only Sanctioned Tournaments are eligible for World Ranking Points. The Ratified Tournaments referred to below are not eligible for World Ranking Points.

When does a Tournament need to be sanctioned?

9. Sanctioning is required when an International Tournament is any of a Category 1 Tournament to a Category 4 Tournament.

10. Sanctioning may, if requested, be granted to a Category 5 International Tournament at the sole discretion of the WPA and upon such additional conditions as it may require.

11. WPA Ratified Events do not require sanctioning. In this regard a WPA Ratified Event is one that has been approved by the WPA Board – see paragraph 58 and following below.

Entry & Sanction fees

12. Tournament Organiser may charge an entry fee to Tournaments. This fee is added to the prize fund for the purpose of calculating a sanctioning or ratifying fee.

13. A sanctioning fee shall be negotiated between the WPA and the Tournament Organiser but will usually be not less than 7.5% of the total added prize money in all Categories.

14. CFs and NFs cannot charge a fee to a Tournament Organiser in respect of a Sanctioned Tournament.

15. An NF cannot charge a fee to a Tournament Organiser in respect of a CF Sanctioned Tournament

Procedure

16. The WPA Board has the right to sanction a Tournament in any country. Prior to a sanction being granted the following steps must be followed:-

    16.1. The WPA Board will not consider any sanctioning application until a corresponding letter from the WPA member is attached to the application, affirming that the CF and its NF have no objection to the sanctioning.

    16.2. This means that any Tournament Organiser that wants to sanction an event with the WPA must first contact the CF and NF responsible for the location where the Tournament will be held.

    16.3. The CF has an obligation to send a final answer to the Tournament Organiser within 14 days after receiving the application from the Tournament Organiser. In this regard the NF must provide any comments it may have to the CF within 7 days.

    16.4. If no timely response is received from the CF, the WPA Board has the right to proceed to decide the sanctioning request.

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16.5. If the CF objects to the Tournament being sanctioned it shall advise the WPA of its reasons in writing at the same time that it advises the Tournament Organiser of its refusal.

16.6. If the Tournament Organiser and the CF agree to extend the 14 day application period, this agreement must be in writing.

17. An application to the WPA Board for sanctioning must use the WPA's published application form unless otherwise agreed by the WPA Board.

18. The CF, its NF and the Tournament Organiser will each provide to the General Secretary copies of all correspondence (including letters, emails and text messages) in relation to an application made under the previous clause as they occur.

19. Notwithstanding an objection by a CF to the sanctioning of a Tournament, the WPA Board may choose to resolve in principle to sanction that Tournament on such terms and conditions as it decides to impose. If this occurs, then the WPA Board will inform the CF in writing of its reasons for sanctioning the Tournament.

20. In relation to the timing of an application for sanctioning or ratification for Championships or Tournaments due to commence after 1 July 2026 the following time requirements shall apply (unless waived or modified by the WPA Board):-

20.1. **Category 1** applications should be made at least 12 months before the date when the World Championship or Tournaments is due to commence;

20.2. **Category 2** applications should be made at least 10 months before the date when the Continental Open Championships or Tournaments are due to commence;

20.3. **Category 3** applications should be made at least 8 months before the date when the Tournament is due to commence;

20.4. **Category 4** applications should be made at least 6 months before the date when the Tournament is due to commence; and

20.5. **Category 5** applications should be made at least 4 months before the date when the Tournament is due to commence**.**

In relation to the timing of an application for sanctioning for Championships or Tournaments due to commence before 1 July 2026, the time requirements shall be dealt with by the WPA on a case by case basis, but applications should be made as soon as possible.

21. An application for sanctioning by a Tournament Organiser shall be in writing and shall include the following:-

21.1. the letter from the CF confirming it has no objection;

21.2. the proposed name of the Tournament;

21.3. the proposed discipline;

21.4. the location and dates of the Tournament;

21.5. the size and gender/s of the playing field;

21.6. the basis upon which Athletes will be invited to participate;

21.7. the amount of the added prize money;

21.8. the proposed entry fee if any; and

21.9. any request for the Tournament to be excused from any of the Rules & Regulations of Pool.

22. Upon receipt of an application in writing for sanctioning, the General Secretary will:

22.1. confirm that it has a letter of support from the relevant CF that it does not object to the Tournament;

22.2. if there is no letter of support, refer the application to the relevant CF; and

22.3. if the CF objects to the Tournament, the General Secretary shall if requested by the Tournament Organiser, refer the matter to the WPA Board.

23. Once a letter of support has been received from a CF, or the WPA Board has resolved in principle to sanction a Tournament under clause 19 above, then the Sports Director will review the application and decide whether to:-

23.1. grant the application;

23.2. grant it on varied terms (including for example the date or location of the Tournament); or

23.3. refuse the application.

24. If the Tournament has a letter of support from a CF and it is proposed that the application will be granted on varied terms, the General Secretary will liaise with the CF about those variations and seek its approval. If approval is not granted clause 19 above may apply.

25. Once the application is granted or the Tournament Organizer has agreed to proceed with the application on the varied terms then:-

25.1. the Sports Director will provide written approval to the Tournament Organiser with the relevant sanctioning conditions for that Tournament;

25.2. the Sports Director will allocate the Tournament with a Tournament Sanction Number;

25.3. The WPA will send an invoice to the Tournament Organizer for payment of the sanction fee.

26. The Tournament Organiser must pay the sanction fee within 14 days of the invoice being issued.

27. Once the sanctioning fee is paid the Sports Director will place the Tournament in the WPA Sports Calendar and will send a Tournament Information Pack to the Tournament Organiser which will include a WPA logo to be used in all Tournament related promotional and advertising activities by the Tournament Organiser.

28. If the sanctioning fee is not paid within 14 days, then the approval of the Tournament may be suspended or cancelled by a decision of the Sports Director.

29. The WPA Board may choose to sanction any Tournament at any time on such terms and conditions as it chooses to impose. These terms may include not awarding World Ranking Points for the Tournament. This sanction may occur irrespective of whether an application has been made or not. If this sanction occurs, then:

29.1. the Sports Director will place the Tournament in the WPA Sports Calendar with the initials (IS) indicating an Imposed Sanction; and

29.2. the WPA Board will inform the CF in writing of its reasons for sanctioning the Tournament.

30. A Tournament may be sanctioned by the WPA Board retrospectively.

31. The General Secretary shall, within 7 days of a request for the Reasons, provide or cause to be provided to the Tournament Organsiser the Reasons.

32. Any Tournament Organiser who is dissatisfied with a refusual by the WPA to sanction a Tournamant or of a condition imposed in respect of the sanction of a Tourament may, lodge an appeal with the WPA Tournament Sanctions Appeal Tribunal. The appeal must be:-

32.1. in writing and submitted to the within 7 days of notification of Reasons; and

32.2. otherwise comply with the requirements in respect of WPA Tournnament Sanctions Appeal Tribunal.

33. There is no right of appeal in respect of a refusal by the WPA to ratify a Tournamant or of a condition imposed in respect of the ratification of a Tournament

Provisional Sanctioning

34. The Board may, in its absolute discretion, agree to provide provisional sanctioning to a prospective tournament or a tournament concept to enable its Tournament Organiser to seek “in principle sponsorship”.

35. The grant of provisional sanctioning will be subject to such terms and conditions as the Board may impose. These terms and conditions may be varied at any time by the Board.

36. The grant of provisional sanctioning does not mean that the tournament or a tournament concept will in fact be sanctioned by the WPA. The Tournament Organiser will need to seek sanctioning following the procedures in these Regulations in the usual way set out above.

37. A Tournament Organiser who has been granted provisional sanctioning shall not use the words “sanctioned by the WPA” or words to that effect and shall not use the WPA logo or other trademarks.

38. A Tournament Organiser who has been granted provisional sanctioning shall not seek or be paid any fee or other benefit nor a procure a promise to be paid any fee or other benefit in the future, based on the provisional sanctioning.

Escrow

39. For all new Tournament Organisers, the prize fund for their first Tournament must be secured in an escrow account nominated by the WPA not less than 60 days prior to the commencement date of the Tournament. This procedure will apply to all new Tournament Organisers. It will also apply to any Tournament Organiser who, in relation to an earlier Tournament, failed to make the prize money payments within 14 days after the Tournament concluded.

40. If the funds have not been secured in escrow as required, the WPA shall advise the Athletes of the situation.

Default

41. If Tournament Organiser is in default of any of its obligations in respect of a Sanctioned Tournament, the WPA may either suspend the sanctioning of the Tournament until the default is remedied or revoke the sanctioning of the Tournament.

Withholding Tax

42. Where it is necessary for tax to be deducted from an Athlete's winnings, tax certificates must be issued by the Tournament Organiser to the Athletes. Details of the procedures concerning tax being withheld and tax certificates must be included in any Tournament information that is given to the Athletes by the Tournament Organiser.

Notification

43. All relevant information regarding the Tournament must be available for the CFs and their NFs to distribute to their Athletes not less than 60 days prior to the Sanctioned Tournament commencing.

44. Athlete registration for a Sanctioned Tournament will occur via a facility on the WPA website.

What benefits do the Tournament Organisers receive from the WPA sanction?

45. The Sanctioned Tournament date will be reserved and must be respected by the WPA's CFs and their NFs.

46. In relation to a Category 1 Tournament.

    46.1. In the case of a World Championship the President (or nominee) will be present. He will arrive 1 day before the Tournament and leave 1 day after the Tournament. The economy class travel costs and the transfers and accommodation costs will be paid by the Tournament Organiser.

    46.2. The Sports Director (or nominee) will be present. He will arrive 2 days before the Tournament and leave 1 day after the Tournament. The travel costs are paid by the WPA, but the transfers and accommodation costs will be paid by the Tournament Organiser. His main role is to support the Tournament Organiser, officials and the Athletes.

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46.3. The WPA supplies the medals when the event being held is an official World Championship.

46.4. If requested, referees can be provided. The costs will be negotiated with the Tournament Organiser by the WPA.

47. Any Tournament information will be distributed and promoted by the WPA, its CFs and their NFs.

48. The use of the WPA logo for publicity purposes is allowed.

What benefits does the venue receive from the WPA sanction?

49. A Sanctioned Tournament distinguishes itself from other tournaments with the prestige of being recognised by the WPA. Sanctioned Tournaments can also unlock available funding from governments and opens more doors with corporate sponsors.

50. In a Sanctioned Tournament the venue is showcasing the best Athletes from around the world and will be mentioned and featured in coverage of the Tournament on all WPA platforms.

51. Finally, the venue has the comfort of knowing that that the highest authority of the sport will deal with any disciplinary issues that may be necessary.

What benefits do the Athletes receive from the WPA sanction?

52. Athletes can be confident that the Tournament and its Tournament Organiser have been vetted by the WPA and that our criteria have been met.

53. Athletes can also be assured of fair play being followed from the draw through to the conclusion of the finals and that the Rules & Regulations of Pool will apply.

54. The WPA will have an official available, at the Tournament or remotely, to assist with any unforeseen circumstances. The WPA will also help in the event that the Tournament Organiser has not paid the prize money in a timely fashion.

55. Athletes receive World Ranking Points from Sanctioned Tournaments which helps them receive invitations to future Tournaments and increases their chances of securing personal sponsors.

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56. The WPA sanctions Tournaments in different disciplines (8-Ball, 9-Ball, 10-Ball, Straight Pool/14.1, Heyball and Blackball). It will endeavour to ensure that two Sanctioned Tournaments do not occur in the same discipline at the same time.

57. The WPA will also seek to coordinate Sanctioned Tournaments wherever possible to enable Athletes to play in multiple Sanctioned Tournaments before leaving one continent to travel to another.

Ratified Events

58. A Tournament Organiser that wants to have a Pool Event ratified by the WPA Board make seek ratification by applying in writing to the Sports Director.

59. An application for ratification by a Tournament Organiser shall be in writing and shall include the following:-

    59.1. the proposed name of the Pool Event;

    59.2. the proposed discipline;

    59.3. the location and dates of the Pool Event;

    59.4. the size and gender/s of the playing field;

    59.5. the basis upon which Athletes will be invited to participate;

    59.6. the amount of the total prize money;

    59.7. the proposed entry fee if any; and

    59.8. any request for the Pool Event to be excused from any of the Rules & Regulations of Pool.

60. The intention of the ratification of Pool Events is to support initiatives which will serve to develop or enhance the game of Pool. Ratified Pool Events may include, but are not limited to, exhibition events, demonstration events, instructional events and experimental events.

61. The WPA Board may in its absolute discretion determine whether an event shall be classified as a WPA Ratified Pool Event.

62. The WPA Board may impose such conditions it considers as appropriate in relation to a WPA Ratified Pool Event.

63. If the application is granted, then:-

63.1. the General Secretary shall provide written approval to the Tournament Organiser with the relevant ratification conditions for that Pool Event;

63.2. The WPA will send an invoice to the Tournament Organizer for payment of any ratification fee.

64. The Tournament Organiser must pay any ratification fee within 14 days of the invoice being issued.

65. Once the ratification fee is paid the Sports Director will place the Ratified Tournament in the WPA Sports Calendar and the General Secretary will send a Tournament Information Pack to the Tournament Organiser. The Tournament Organiser will include a WPA logo in all Tournament related promotional and advertising activities by the Tournament Organiser.

66. If the ratification fee is not paid within 14 days, then the approval of the WPA Ratified Pool Event may be suspended or cancelled by a decision of the Sports Director.

67. An event may be classified as a WPA Ratified Pool Event retrospectively.

68. WPA Ratified Pool Events do not receive World Ranking Points.

69. Only the WPA may ratify events.

Continental Tournaments

70. CFs may sanction Continental Tournaments. Ideally CFs should agree on a consistent approach so that our international Tournament Organisers working on continental tournaments enjoy the same process with each CF.

71. CF sanctioning regulations for a CF Sanctioned Tournament should be consistent in philosophy and approach to the WPA regulations above

National Tournaments

72. NFs may sanction National Tournaments.

73. NF sanctioning regulations for a NF Sanctioned Tournament should be consistent in philosophy and approach to the WPA regulations above and to their relevant CF regulations.

Appendix A

National Olympic Committees

AFRICA

Algeria

Angola

Benin

Botswana

Burkina Faso

Burundi

Cabo Verde

Cameroon

Central African Republic

Chad

Comoros

Congo

Congo, Democratic Republic of the

Djibouti

Egypt

Equatorial Guinea

Eritrea

Eswatini

Ethiopia

Gabon

Gambia

Ghana

Guinea

Guinea-Bissau

Ivory Coast

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Lesotho

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